



Color TV Game

Over the course of its production run, 40 different manufacturers created more than 200 different games for the system, selling more than 120 million cartridges of popular games such as Space Invaders, Asteroids, and Pac-Man. Since its biggest competitor, the Channel F, didn't possess half the graphics or sound capabilities of the 2600, and didn't have the kind of publicity a corporate giant like Warner Communications could roll out for it, only 26 titles were ever released for the Channel F, and despite its earlier release, Fairchild soon succumbed to the Atari sales dominance.

The release of the Atari 2600 created panic in other companies, and forced them to up their ante as well. Magnavox responded by releasing a pared down and more robust version of the Odyssey, called Odyssey². By that time, Magnavox had been acquired by Phillips, so all Odyssey consoles were sold under the aegis of Phillips. Compared to its predecessor, the Odyssey² was highly improved. Each game was a unique experience, and didn't need changing background overlays. Games had their own background and foreground graphics, sound effects, scoring and individual storylines. Players could purchase individual games and thus, build up entire libraries. In addition, the makers of the Odyssey² included a full alphanumeric keyboard that could be used to educate people about simple computer programming and other basic educational tools.